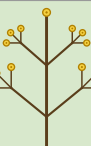


Family Finder — British Vascular Plants Flowers not green or brown · radially or bilaterally symmetric · herbaceous plants

Flower arrangement	 3 or 6 petals (or multiples)	 4 petals	 5 petals joined (tubular / bell)	 5 petals free	 7+ petals	 Bilateral flowers			
 Single or pair	Amaryllidaceae Iridaceae Liliaceae Colchicaceae Aristolochiaceae Hydrocharitaceae Alismataceae	Papaveraceae Rosaceae Onagraceae Caryophyllaceae Gentianaceae	Primulaceae Ericaceae Convolvulaceae Campanulaceae Apocynaceae	Gentianaceae Solanaceae Caprifoliaceae Menyanthaceae	Ranunculaceae Rosaceae Geraniaceae Caryophyllaceae Hypericaceae Oxalidaceae Saxifragaceae	Parnassiaceae Malvaceae Paeoniaceae Linaceae Cistaceae Portulacaceae Limnanthaceae	Ranunculaceae Nymphaeaceae Primulaceae Rosaceae Gentianaceae	Paeoniaceae Aizoaceae (Asteraceae - check!) (Caryophyllaceae - check!)	Fabaceae Violaceae Balsaminaceae Caprifoliaceae Lentibulariaceae Ranunculaceae Orchidaceae
 In Leaf Axils	Liliaceae Lythraceae Aristolochiaceae	Onagraceae Rosaceae Rubiaceae Caryophyllaceae (Veronicaceae - <i>Veronica</i> ; bilateral)	Boraginaceae Ericaceae Primulaceae Campanulaceae Convolvulaceae Apocynaceae Solanaceae Curcubitaceae	Malvaceae Hypericaceae Caryophyllaceae Polygonaceae Crassulaceae Rosaceae Primulaceae Lythraceae	Portulacaceae Linaceae Cistaceae Oxalidaceae Saxifragaceae (Solanaceae - <i>Solanum</i> ?) Santalaceae Frankeniaceae	Aizoaceae (Caryophyllaceae - check!) (Onagraceae - check!)	Lamiaceae Veronicaceae Caprifoliaceae Fabaceae Onagraceae Violaceae	Balsaminaceae Phrymaceae Scrophulariaceae Orobanchaceae Tropaeolaceae - <i>Tropaeolum</i>	
 Spike or Raceme	Liliaceae Lythraceae Dioscoreaceae Alismataceae Asparagaceae Amaryllidaceae	Resedaceae Polygonaceae Iridaceae Scheuchzeriaceae Asphodelaceae	Brassicaceae Onagraceae Resedaceae Polygonaceae	Campanulaceae Boraginaceae Ericaceae Menyanthaceae Crassulaceae Primulaceae Curcubitaceae Resedaceae	Rosaceae Lythraceae Resedaceae Polygonaceae Saxifragaceae Droseraceae	Linaceae Cistaceae Portulacaceae Ranunculaceae Santalaceae	(Brassicaceae - <i>Draba</i> ? Check!) (Onagraceae - <i>Epilobium</i> ? Check!) Resedaceae	Lamiaceae Veronicaceae Scrophulariaceae Papaveraceae (Fumarioideae) Fabaceae Onagraceae (<i>Chamaenerion</i>) Orchidaceae Polygalaceae Balsaminaceae	Verbenaceae Brassicaceae (<i>Iberis</i> , <i>Teesdalia</i>) Ranunculaceae Resedaceae Campanulaceae Iridaceae (e.g. <i>Crocsmia</i>) Lentibulariaceae Boraginaceae
 Umbel	Liliaceae Amaryllidaceae Butomaceae (Alismataceae - not true umbels)	Papaveraceae	Primulaceae Curcubitaceae	Apiaceae Geraniaceae Oxalidaceae Rosaceae		Apiaceae (outer florets only) Fabaceae			
 Complex group	Dioscoreaceae Alismataceae Asparagaceae Polygonaceae Rosaceae Rubiaceae	Rubiaceae (Rosaceae - <i>Alchemilla</i> ; sepals?) Brassicaceae Crassulaceae Saxifragaceae Gentianaceae Onagraceae (Veronicaceae - <i>Veronica</i>)	Boraginaceae Valerianaceae Gentianaceae Primulaceae Solanaceae	Rubiaceae (<i>Rubia</i>) Polemoniaceae Plumbaginaceae Caprifoliaceae Ericaceae	Rosaceae Hypericaceae Polygonaceae Caryophyllaceae Saxifragaceae Crassulaceae	Malvaceae Ranunculaceae Geraniaceae Linaceae Portulacaceae (Solanaceae)	(Asteraceae - actually a tight head) (Caryophyllaceae - bifid petals) Ranunculaceae Rosaceae Gentianaceae (<i>Blackstonia</i>)	Scrophulariaceae Valerianaceae Balsaminaceae Lamiaceae Polemoniaceae Boraginaceae	
 Tight head	Asparagaceae Amaryllidaceae Asphodelaceae	Dipsacaceae Rosaceae Brassicaceae Eriocaulaceae Polygonaceae Rubiaceae (Asteraceae)	Asteraceae Dipsacaceae Campanulaceae (Boraginaceae) Valerianaceae Convolvulaceae	Caryophyllaceae Rosaceae Apiaceae Plumbaginaceae Cannabinaceae (Asteraceae) Polygonaceae	(Asteraceae - 5 fused petals) (Caryophyllaceae - bifid petals)	Fabaceae Asteraceae (ray florets) Lamiaceae Dipsacaceae Valerianaceae Caprifoliaceae			

Notes

- Families arranged in order of occurrence (column-wise)
- Family names follow Stace (2019).
- Liliaceae s.l. split into Amaryllidaceae, Melanthiaceae., etc
- Scrophulariaceae s.l. split into Plantaginaceae, Veronicaceae, etc.

Green / brown flowers For plants with inconspicuous green or brown flowers consider: Poaceae (grasses), Cyperaceae (sedges), Juncaceae (rushes), Polygonaceae, Urticaceae, Amaranthaceae (incl. Chenopodiaceae), Euphorbiaceae, Plantaginaceae (*Plantago*), *Rumex*, *Arum* (Araceae). Flowers lack obvious petals; see Table 1, page 2 for a key.

This table does not cover

- Trees/shrubs → Table 2 (p. 2)
- Aquatic plants → Table 3 (p. 2)
- No chlorophyll → Table 4 (p. 2)

Table 1 · Green/Brown Flowers — herbs

Flower arrangement	Broad leaves		Grass-like leaves	
 Single / pair	(Araceae - monoecious spike) Plantaginaceae Caryophyllaceae Asparagaceae Amaryllidaceae Melianthaceae (<i>Paris</i>) Euphorbiaceae		Caryophyllaceae	
 Leaf axils	Polygonaceae Amaranthaceae (incl. <i>Chenopodium</i>) Rosaceae Euphorbiaceae Urticaceae	Caryophyllaceae Callitrichaceae Santalaceae Rubiaceae	Caryophyllaceae Amaranthaceae	
 Spike / raceme	Plantaginaceae (<i>Plantago</i>) Polygonaceae (<i>Rumex</i>) Amaranthaceae Resedaceae Euphorbiaceae Urticaceae	Cannabianaceae Curcubitaceae Potamogetonaceae Araceae Scheuchzeriaceae	Poaceae Cyperaceae Resedaceae Typhaceae Juncaginaceae	Araceae Orchidaceae Acoraceae Potamogetonaceae Polygonaceae
 Umbel	Araliaceae Curcubitaceae Apiaceae			
 Complex group	Polygonaceae Amaranthaceae Euphorbiaceae Rosaceae Urticaceae	Cannabinaceae Saxifragaceae Gunneraceae Curcubitaceae Scrophulariaceae	Poaceae Cyperaceae Juncaceae Amaranthaceae Polygonaceae	
 Tight head	Plantaginaceae Euphorbiaceae Amaranthaceae Rosaceae Typhaceae	Adoxaceae Cannabinaceae Asteraceae Santalaceae	Juncaceae Poaceae Cyperaceae Typhaceae	

Table 2 · Trees, Shrubs, Woody Climbers · Petal counts in brackets

a. Coloured (not green/brown) flowers — broken down by colour within radial symmetry

Flower shape	 White / cream	 Yellow	 Pink / purple	 Bilateral
 Petals free	Rosaceae (5) Cornaceae (4) Aquifoliaceae (4) Hydrangaceae (4-5) Tamaricaceae (5) Passifloraceae (5; corona of many infertile stamens) Rutaceae (5; <i>Choisya</i>)	Hypericaceae (5) Cornaceae (4) Berberidaceae (many) Grossulariaceae (5; <i>Ribes odoratum</i>) Rosaceae (5; <i>Kerria</i>) Sapindaceae (4; <i>Koelreuteria</i>) Rutaceae (4-5; <i>Ruta</i>)	Onagraceae (4; <i>Fuchsia</i>) Grossulariaceae (5; <i>Ribes sanguineum</i>) Rosaceae (5; <i>Spiraea</i>) Ericaceae (3; <i>Empetrum</i>) Tamaricaceae (5) Thymeleaceae (4; <i>Daphne</i> , actually sepals) Rutaceae (4 joined; <i>Correa</i>)	Fabaceae (5) Hippocastanaceae (4-5)
 Petals joined	Caprifoliaceae (5) Rhamnaceae (5) Oleaceae (4-6) Viburnaceae (5) Sambucaceae (5) Ericaceae (4-5) Myrtaceae (4-5) Simaroubaceae (5; <i>Ailanthus</i>)	Oleaceae (4-6; <i>Jasminum</i> , <i>Forsythia</i>)	Scrophulariaceae (4) Ericaceae (4-5) Solanaceae (5) Oleaceae (4-6)	Caprifoliaceae (5) Ericaceae (5) Paulowniaceae (5)

b. Green/brown flowers

 Catkins	 Flower-shaped (greenish)	Other	
Salicaceae Betulaceae Fagaceae Myricaceae Juglandaceae	Sapindaceae Malvaceae Celastraceae Rhamnaceae Thymeleaceae Grossulariaceae Amaranthaceae Anacardiaceae (dense (<i>Rhus</i>) or diffuse (<i>Cotinus</i>))	Ulmaceae (small axillary clusters) Vitaceae (woody climber, leaf opposed infls) Platanaceae (globose pendant heads) Oleaceae (axillary clusters) Eleagnaceae (axillary clusters)	Buxaceae (monoecious clusters) Moraceae (very odd fls; <i>Ficus</i> or <i>Morus</i>) Nothofagaceae Myrtaceae (<i>Eucalyptus</i>)

Table 3 · Fully Aquatic Plants

Tiny flowers (<2 mm)			Conspicuous / white flowers	
<i>Leaves all at stem base</i>	<i>Leaves all along stem</i>		<i>Tiny floating plant</i>	
Zosteraceae Plantaginaceae Callitrichaceae Brassicaceae Eriocaulaceae	Callitrichaceae Potamogetonaceae Haloragaceae (whorled; finely pinnate) Hippuridaceae Hydrocharitaceae Typhaceae	Ceratophyllaceae (whorled; bifid) Elatinaceae Cyperaceae Zannichellaceae Ruppiaceae	Araceae (Lemnoidae)	Nymphaeaceae Menyanthaceae Polygonaceae Hydrocharitaceae Alismataceae Campanulaceae Lentibulariaceae Ranunculaceae Primulaceae (<i>Samolus</i>) Butomaceae

Table 4 · Without Chlorophyll

Mode	Families / notes
Root parasite	Orobanchaceae (<i>Orobanche</i> , <i>Lathraea</i>)
Stem parasite	Convolvulaceae (<i>Cuscuta</i>)
Mycoheterotrophic	Ericaceae (<i>Monotropa</i>) Orchidaceae (<i>Neottia nidus-avis</i>)